

Reading

The Letter I Never Sent

Before you read

- What is something you wish you had done differently at school?
- Look at the title. What do you think the writer regrets?

When I was seventeen, my best friend Deniz moved to another city with her family. We promised to write letters every week, but somehow life got busy and I never kept my promise. If I had written to her just once a month, our friendship would have survived the distance. Instead, the letters stopped after only a few weeks, and slowly we lost touch completely.

Last year, I found an old, unfinished letter to Deniz in a box under my bed. I had started it years ago but never finished it, and I never sent it. Reading it again, I realised how much I regretted losing such an important friendship. If I hadn't been so lazy about writing back then, we might still be close friends today. I wish I had understood, at seventeen, how rare a good friendship really is.

This year, I finally decided to do something about it. I found Deniz on social media and sent her a message, admitting that I wished I had kept in touch all those years ago. To my surprise, she replied within a day. She told me that she had often wondered what would have happened if either of us had made more effort. We are now planning to meet for coffee next month, twenty years after we last saw each other.

Looking back, I don't think either of us was a bad friend — we were just young and didn't understand how quickly people can drift apart. If we had known then what we know now, we would have made more time for each other. But I've also learned that it's never too late to fix a mistake from the past, even if it takes twenty years to do it.

1. Why did the writer and Deniz lose touch?
 - a. They had an argument.
 - b. They stopped writing letters regularly.
 - c. Deniz didn't want to be friends anymore.
 - d. The writer moved away first.
2. The writer sent the unfinished letter to Deniz years ago. — *True / False*
3. The writer says: 'I wish I _____ how rare a good friendship really is.'
4. How did Deniz react when the writer contacted her again?
 - a. She ignored the message.
 - b. She was angry.
 - c. She replied quickly and was open to reconnecting.
 - d. She said it was too late.

5. According to the text, what does the writer believe about fixing past mistakes? Write one sentence using your own words. (The writer believes ...)

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6. What is the main idea of the last paragraph?

- a. Friendships never last.
- b. People should blame themselves for losing friends.
- c. It's never too late to repair a lost friendship.
- d. Social media is the best way to make new friends.

After you read

- Do you agree that it's never too late to fix a friendship? Why or why not?
- Have you ever reconnected with someone from your past? What happened?

What If the Bridge Hadn't Been Built?

Before you read

- Think of one famous building or structure in your city or country. Why is it important?
- What do you think would be different if a famous bridge in your country had never been built?

Every town has a story about a decision that changed everything. In one small coastal town, local leaders had to decide whether to build a bridge connecting it to the mainland. Many people were against the idea; they worried that a bridge would destroy the town's quiet, traditional way of life. If the town council had listened to these voices, the bridge would never have been built.

However, the council decided to go ahead with the project. The bridge opened fifteen years ago, and the town changed completely. Tourists began arriving by car instead of by the old, slow ferry. New hotels, cafés, and shops appeared along the coast. If the bridge hadn't been built, none of this growth would have happened, and the town might still look exactly as it did decades ago.

Not everyone is happy with the changes. Some older residents say that if the town had stayed isolated, it would have kept its peaceful character. They believe the fishing community that once defined the town has been replaced by a tourist economy that cares more about profit than tradition. They often wonder what would have happened if the bridge project had been rejected all those years ago.

Younger residents, on the other hand, tend to see the bridge differently. Many of them would have had to leave the town to find work if the bridge — and the tourism it brought — hadn't been built. For them, the bridge didn't destroy the town; it saved it from slowly disappearing as young people moved away. Both sides agree on one thing: that single decision changed the town's future forever.

1. Why were some people originally against building the bridge?

- a. It was too expensive.
- b. They thought it would destroy the town's traditional way of life.
- c. They didn't trust the council.
- d. There was no need for tourists.

2. If the bridge _____ (not/build), the town might still look exactly as it did decades ago.

3. All residents agree that the bridge was a bad decision. — *True / False*

4. According to younger residents, what would have happened without the bridge?

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- a. The town would have grown faster.
- b. Many young people would have had to leave to find work.
- c. Tourism would have increased anyway.
- d. Nothing would have changed.

5. Summarise in one sentence how the bridge changed the town's economy. (*The bridge changed the town's economy by ...*)

After you read

- Do you think the council made the right decision? Why or why not?
- Can you think of a real decision in your own country that changed a place forever?